LABOUR SOCIAL SECURITY, UNORGANISED AND GIG WORKERS

STATUS LADDER → THREE STATUTORY CATEGORIES → CONTRIBUTION FRAMEWORK CARD → REGISTRATION TO BENEFIT → DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS → SCALE ANCHOR CARD

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

STATUS LADDER

STATUS LADDER | RUNG 1 | THE CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY, 2020 IS PASSED | RUNG 2 | BROUGHT INTO FORCE ON 21 NOVEMBER 2025 | RUNG 3 | RULES AND SCHEME | FINAL CENTRAL RULES NOTIFIED IN MAY 2026; STATE RULES

RUNG 1 → enacted: the Code on Social Security, 2020 is passed

RUNG 2 → commenced: brought into force on 21 November 2025 → RUNG 3 → rules and scheme: final Central Rules notified in May 2026; State rules → RUNG 4 → collected: a notified rate and an administered contribution ledger

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- RUNG 1 → enacted: the Code on Social Security, 2020 is passed
- RUNG 2 → commenced: brought into force on 21 November 2025

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- RUNG 3 → rules and scheme: final Central Rules notified in May 2026; State rules pending relevance
- RUNG 4 → collected: a notified rate and an administered contribution ledger

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RUNG 5 → delivered: registration, claims rules, grievance redress and a benefit received
- RUNG 1 → enacted: the Code on Social Security, 2020 is passed

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RUNG 5 → delivered: registration, claims rules, grievance redress and a benefit received.

01

STAGE 01

THREE STATUTORY CATEGORIES

THREE STATUTORY CATEGORIES | GIG WORKER | EARNS FROM WORK OUTSIDE A TRADITIONAL EMPLOYER-EMPLOYEE RELATIONSHIP | PLATFORM WORKER | WORKS OUTSIDE THAT RELATIONSHIP THROUGH AN ONLINE PLATFORM FOR | DIGITAL INTERMEDIARY OR MARKETPLACE CONNECTING USER AND PROVIDER | THE FIRST TWO ARE WORKER CATEGORIES; THE THIRD IS | A DEFINITION CREATES ELIGIBILITY TO BE COVERED, NOT A

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship	AGGREGATOR → digital intermediary or marketplace connecting user and provider	LIMIT → a definition creates eligibility to be covered, not a benefit
PLATFORM WORKER → works outside that relationship through an online platform for payment	ROLE → the first two are worker categories; the third is the financing node	GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship
- PLATFORM WORKER → works outside that relationship through an online platform for payment

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- AGGREGATOR → digital intermediary or marketplace connecting user and provider
- ROLE → the first two are worker categories; the third is the financing node

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- LIMIT → a definition creates eligibility to be covered, not a benefit
- GIG WORKER → earns from work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a definition creates eligibility to be covered, not a benefit.

02

STAGE 02

CONTRIBUTION FRAMEWORK CARD

CONTRIBUTION FRAMEWORK CARD | SECTION 114 OF THE CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY, 2020 | RATE FLOOR | AT LEAST ONE PER CENT OF AN AGGREGATOR'S ANNUAL | RATE CEILING | NOT MORE THAN TWO PER CENT OF THAT ANNUAL | PAYOUT CAP | FIVE PER CENT OF AMOUNTS PAID OR PAYABLE TO

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020	RATE CEILING → not more than two per cent of that annual turnover	STATUS → a framework for a notified rate; not proof of a collected levy
RATE FLOOR → at least one per cent of an aggregator's annual turnover	PAYOUT CAP → five per cent of amounts paid or payable to gig and platform workers	PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020
- RATE FLOOR → at least one per cent of an aggregator's annual turnover

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- RATE CEILING → not more than two per cent of that annual turnover
- PAYOUT CAP → five per cent of amounts paid or payable to gig and platform workers

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- STATUS → a framework for a notified rate; not proof of a collected levy
- PROVISION → Section 114 of the Code on Social Security, 2020

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATUS → a framework for a notified rate; not proof of a collected levy.

03

STAGE 03

REGISTRATION TO BENEFIT

REGISTRATION TO BENEFIT | DATABASE ENTRY | IDENTITY RECORDED WITH A UNIVERSAL ACCOUNT NUMBER SINCE 2021 | SCHEME MATCHING | AGE, INCOME, OCCUPATION, CONTRIBUTION AND DOCUMENTATION RULES APPLY | PAYMENT FRICTION | BANK ACCESS, DOCUMENTS, AWARENESS AND DATA QUALITY CAN INTERRUPT | OUTCOME RISK

DATABASE ENTRY → identity recorded with a universal account number since 2021 → SCHEME MATCHING: age, income, occupation, contribution and documentation rules apply → PAYMENT FRICTION: bank access, documents, awareness and data quality can interrupt → OUTCOME RISK: a high registration total can coexist with low pension or insurance uptake → RULE → registration is necessary and is not sufficient

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- DATABASE ENTRY → identity recorded with a universal account number since 2021
- SCHEME MATCHING: age, income, occupation, contribution and documentation rules apply

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- PAYMENT FRICTION: bank access, documents, awareness and data quality can interrupt
- OUTCOME RISK: a high registration total can coexist with low pension or insurance uptake

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RULE → registration is necessary and is not sufficient
- DATABASE ENTRY → identity recorded with a universal account number since 2021

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → registration is necessary and is not sufficient.

04

STAGE 04

DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS

DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS | PENSION ROUTE | VOLUNTARY, CONTRIBUTORY, MATCHING CONTRIBUTIONS, SEPARATE ENROLMENT REQUIRED | PENSION VALUE | THREE THOUSAND RUPEES PER MONTH AFTER AGE SIXTY, SUBJECT | CONSTRUCTION BOARDS | STATE BOARDS UNDER THE 1996 FRAMEWORK, FUNDED BY THE | FORMAL SECTOR

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required	CONSTRUCTION BOARDS → State boards under the 1996 framework, funded by the welfare cess	RULE → identify the owning institution before judging whether a worker is protected
PENSION VALUE → three thousand rupees per month after age sixty, subject to conditions	FORMAL SECTOR → provident fund and employee insurance where the applicable statutes cover	PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required
- PENSION VALUE → three thousand rupees per month after age sixty, subject to conditions

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- CONSTRUCTION BOARDS → State boards under the 1996 framework, funded by the welfare cess
- FORMAL SECTOR → provident fund and employee insurance where the applicable statutes cover

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- RULE → identify the owning institution before judging whether a worker is protected
- PENSION ROUTE → voluntary, contributory, matching contributions, separate enrolment required

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → identify the owning institution before judging whether a worker is protected.

05

STAGE 05

SCALE ANCHOR CARD

SCALE ANCHOR CARD | A 2022 REPORT OF THE NATIONAL POLICY THINK TANK | 7.7 MILLION GIG WORKERS IN 2020-21 | 23.5 MILLION BY 2029-30 | A SCENARIO, NOT A WORKER REGISTRY OR A BENEFICIARY | BACKGROUND STATUTE | THE UNORGANISED WORKERS' SOCIAL SECURITY ACT, 2008

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
SOURCE → a 2022 report of the national policy think tank	PROJECTION → 23.5 million by 2029-30	BACKGROUND STATUTE → the Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008
ESTIMATE → 7.7 million gig workers in 2020-21	STATUS → a scenario, not a worker registry or a beneficiary count	SOURCE → a 2022 report of the national policy think tank

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- SOURCE → a 2022 report of the national policy think tank
- ESTIMATE → 7.7 million gig workers in 2020-21

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- PROJECTION → 23.5 million by 2029-30
- STATUS → a scenario, not a worker registry or a beneficiary count

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- BACKGROUND STATUTE → the Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008
- SOURCE → a 2022 report of the national policy think tank

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BACKGROUND STATUTE → the Unorganised Workers' Social Security Act, 2008.

06

STAGE 06

PLATFORM-POWER CHAIN

PLATFORM-POWER CHAIN | ALGORITHMIC CONTROL | RATINGS, INCENTIVES, TASK ALLOCATION AND DEACTIVATION | INCOME VOLATILITY | VARIABLE DEMAND AND UNILATERAL INCENTIVE CHANGES | CONTRIBUTION DIFFICULTY | IRREGULAR EARNINGS OBSTRUCT REGULAR CONTRIBUTIONS | CLASSIFICATION BOUNDARY

ALGORITHMIC CONTROL → ratings, incentives, task allocation and deactivation

INCOME VOLATILITY → variable demand and unilateral incentive changes → CONTRIBUTION DIFFICULTY → irregular earnings obstruct regular contributions → CLASSIFICATION BOUNDARY → recognition does not settle every labour-standard dispute

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- ALGORITHMIC CONTROL → ratings, incentives, task allocation and deactivation
- INCOME VOLATILITY → variable demand and unilateral incentive changes

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- CONTRIBUTION DIFFICULTY → irregular earnings obstruct regular contributions
- CLASSIFICATION BOUNDARY → recognition does not settle every labour-standard dispute

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- VOICE GAP → an application grievance channel is not bargaining or adjudication
- ALGORITHMIC CONTROL → ratings, incentives, task allocation and deactivation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VOICE GAP → an application grievance channel is not bargaining or adjudication.

07

STAGE 07

PORTABILITY TEST

PORTABILITY TEST | PORTABLE CARD | A UNIVERSAL ACCOUNT NUMBER THAT FOLLOWS THE WORKER | PORTABLE BENEFIT | CONTRIBUTION RECORDS THAT FOLLOW THE WORKER AS WELL | ALSO REQUIRED | ELIGIBILITY RULES, CLAIM SETTLEMENT AND GRIEVANCE ACROSS STATES AND | A BOARD-REGISTERED CONSTRUCTION WORKER HOLDS A BENEFIT; A DATABASE-ONLY

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker	ALSO REQUIRED → eligibility rules, claim settlement and grievance across States and platforms	RISK → cross-platform data creates surveillance exposure needing purpose limitation and consent
PORTABLE BENEFIT → contribution records that follow the worker as well	CONTRAST → a board-registered construction worker holds a benefit; a database-only worker may not	PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker
- PORTABLE BENEFIT → contribution records that follow the worker as well

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- ALSO REQUIRED → eligibility rules, claim settlement and grievance across States and platforms
- CONTRAST → a board-registered construction worker holds a benefit; a database-only worker may not

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- RISK → cross-platform data creates surveillance exposure needing purpose limitation and consent
- PORTABLE CARD → a universal account number that follows the worker

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RISK → cross-platform data creates surveillance exposure needing purpose limitation and consent.

08

STAGE 08

FINANCING MIX

FINANCING MIX | TAX-FINANCED FLOOR | REDUCES EXCLUSION OF LOW AND IRREGULAR EARNERS; HIGHER FISCAL | CONTRIBUTORY TOP-UP | DEEPENS COVER; EXCLUDES WORKERS WITH VOLATILE EARNINGS | AGGREGATOR LEVY | PLACES THE OBLIGATION ON THE PARTY WITH TURNOVER AND | THE LEVY MAY BE PASSED TO WORKERS OR USERS

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost	AGGREGATOR LEVY → places the obligation on the party with turnover and data	CONCLUSION → a credible gig model usually needs both floor and top-up
CONTRIBUTORY TOP-UP → deepens cover; excludes workers with volatile earnings	INCIDENCE → the levy may be passed to workers or users; transparency and analysis needed	TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost
- CONTRIBUTORY TOP-UP → deepens cover; excludes workers with volatile earnings

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- AGGREGATOR LEVY → places the obligation on the party with turnover and data
- INCIDENCE → the levy may be passed to workers or users; transparency and analysis needed

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- CONCLUSION → a credible gig model usually needs both floor and top-up
- TAX-FINANCED FLOOR → reduces exclusion of low and irregular earners; higher fiscal cost

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONCLUSION → a credible gig model usually needs both floor and top-up.

09

STAGE 09

PROHIBITED INVENTIONS

PROHIBITED INVENTIONS | NO THRESHOLD | NO NINETY-DAY OR ONE-HUNDRED-AND-TWENTY-DAY NATIONAL ELIGIBILITY RULE | NO LEVY CLAIM | NO ASSERTION OF A COLLECTED NATIONWIDE CONTRIBUTION OR FUND | NO STATUS UPGRADE | A DEFINITION DOES NOT SETTLE WAGES, HOURS, DISMISSAL OR | NO INSURANCE SHORTCUT

NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule → NO LEVY CLAIM → no assertion of a collected nationwide contribution or fund balance → NO STATUS UPGRADE → a definition does not settle wages, hours, dismissal or bargaining → NO INSURANCE SHORTCUT → hospitalisation cover does not correct pay or deactivation → NO KEY → no option or answer letter for the routed objective demand

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule
- NO LEVY CLAIM → no assertion of a collected nationwide contribution or fund balance

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- NO STATUS UPGRADE → a definition does not settle wages, hours, dismissal or bargaining
- NO INSURANCE SHORTCUT → hospitalisation cover does not correct pay or deactivation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NO KEY → no option or answer letter for the routed objective demand
- NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO THRESHOLD → no ninety-day or one-hundred-and-twenty-day national eligibility rule.

10

STAGE 10

ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMAND

ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMAND | YEAR AND PAPER | 2024 PRELIMS GENERAL STUDIES PAPER I, QUESTION NUMBERED 100 | THE UNORGANISED-WORKER PENSION ROUTE, RENDERED NEUTRALLY IN THE AUDITED | KEY STATUS | OFFICIAL SET-A KEY AVAILABLE LOCALLY; THE ANSWER IS NOT | PACKAGE RULE | NO OPTION, KEY OR INFERRED ANSWER LETTER IS STATED

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100	KEY STATUS → official Set-A key available locally; the answer is not recorded there	COVERAGE → voluntary enrolment, matching contributions; pension after sixty, taught as content
DEMAND → the unorganised-worker pension route, rendered neutrally in the audited ledger	PACKAGE RULE → no option, key or inferred answer letter is stated anywhere here	YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100
- DEMAND → the unorganised-worker pension route, rendered neutrally in the audited ledger

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- KEY STATUS → official Set-A key available locally; the answer is not recorded there
- PACKAGE RULE → no option, key or inferred answer letter is stated anywhere here

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- COVERAGE → voluntary enrolment, matching contributions, pension after sixty, taught as content
- YEAR AND PAPER → 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I, question numbered 100

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PACKAGE RULE → no option, key or inferred answer letter is stated anywhere here.

11

STAGE 11

REFORM ARCHITECTURE AND ITS COSTS

REFORM ARCHITECTURE AND ITS COSTS | PUBLISH STATUS | PROVISION-SPECIFIC COMMENCEMENT AND SCHEME STATUS MADE READABLE | AUDITABLE FUND | RECEIPTS AND CLAIMS OPEN TO INSPECTION | ASSISTED ENROLMENT | OFFLINE ROUTES SO DIGITAL EXCLUSION IS NOT BENEFIT EXCLUSION | INDEPENDENT GRIEVANCE

PUBLISH STATUS → provision-specific commencement and scheme status made readable → AUDITABLE FUND: receipts and claims open to inspection → ASSISTED ENROLMENT: offline routes so digital exclusion is not benefit exclusion → INDEPENDENT GRIEVANCE: a forum for deactivation and benefit disputes → COSTS → levy incidence, threshold exclusion, privacy exposure, insurance-led narrowness

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- PUBLISH STATUS → provision-specific commencement and scheme status made readable
- AUDITABLE FUND: receipts and claims open to inspection

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- ASSISTED ENROLMENT: offline routes so digital exclusion is not benefit exclusion
- INDEPENDENT GRIEVANCE: a forum for deactivation and benefit disputes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COSTS → levy incidence, threshold exclusion, privacy exposure, insurance-led narrowness
- PUBLISH STATUS → provision-specific commencement and scheme status made readable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COSTS → levy incidence, threshold exclusion, privacy exposure, insurance-led narrowness.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY, 2020 | ENACTED FRAMEWORK THAT CONTAINS GIG/PLATFORM | DELIVERY INSTITUTIONS | EPFO, ESIC AND STATE BOCW WELFARE BOARDS REMAIN CENTRAL | MOLE NATIONAL DATABASE/UAN INFRASTRUCTURE; USEFUL FOR MAPPING AND | VOLUNTARY CONTRIBUTORY PENSION ROUTE FOR ELIGIBLE UNORGANISED WORKERS | RECOMMENDED DESIGN

OPTIONAL RIGHTS AND CAPABILITY DEPTH

- Code on Social Security, 2020: enacted framework that contains gig/platform
- Delivery institutions: EPFO, ESIC and State BOCW Welfare Boards remain central
- e-Shram: MoLE national database/UAN infrastructure; useful for mapping and
- PM-SYM: voluntary contributory pension route for eligible unorganised workers;

INDICATOR, ROUND AND STATUS LIMIT

- CAUTION: Recommended design: publish provision-specific commencement and scheme status;
- CAUTION: A rider engaged through two platforms may satisfy the Code definitions but still
- CAUTION: A BOCW-registered migrant construction worker may receive a State-board benefit;
- CAUTION: A platform calling a worker a "partner" may not defeat a future social-security

COMPARATIVE WELFARE-DESIGN NUANCE

- CAUTION: Contribution incidence: An aggregator levy can finance protection but may be
- CAUTION: Threshold design: Any work-day/earnings threshold could simplify administration
- CAUTION: Data minimisation: Cross-platform portability improves protection but creates
- CAUTION: Insurance-led bias: Hospitalisation or accident cover alone cannot correct

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels